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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: **DJIA** 52002.41 ▲ 347.46 0.67% **NASDAQ** 26140.03 ▼ 4.5% **STOXX 600** 644.74 ▲ 2.09% **10-YR. TREASURY** ▲ 1 3/32, yield 5.097% **OIL** $101.41 ▲ $9.56 **EURO** $1.1241 **YEN** 158.00

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **SoftBank is in talks** to acquire Allied Universal from its private-equity backers in what would be the tech conglomerate's latest bet on widespread adoption of AI and robotics in the workplace. **B1**

◆ **China's economy** expanded at a 4.5% clip in the third quarter, at the low end of the government's full-year growth target. **A10**

◆ **Airfares this holiday** season will be the highest in at least a decade, data compiled by booking company Hopper show. **A1**

◆ **The summer surge** in federal immigration raids is hitting the housing market, pushing up labor costs and freezing projects. **A2**

◆ **Nearly all volume** on FIFA-allied prediction-market operator ADI Predictstreet is among a small network of linked accounts, suggesting it is inauthentic. **B3**

◆ **"Street Fighter" took** top billing at the domestic movie box office, earning $31 million in its first weekend. **B2**

◆ **Linda Yaccarino, a** former CEO of Musk's X, is joining the board of digital mortgage lender Better.com. **B4**

◆ **Big law firms have** embraced modern branding techniques to lure and retain clients as they aim to compete within a shrinking pool of ever-larger rivals. **B5**

◆ **Companies planning** data centers are projecting themselves as more attentive to the concerns of people near the proposed sites. **B5**

Worldwide

◆ **Russian President** Vladimir Putin proposed that he, Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping meet next month to talk about Ukraine in an attempt to negotiate an end to the four-year conflict that would favor Moscow. **A1, A5-6**

◆ **Trump's surprise diesel** deal with Russia and decision to waive sanctions on Moscow have become a headache for Republican candidates with just two weeks to go before the midterm elections **A5**

◆ **Republicans across** the most competitive House and Senate races are pitching the idea that Democrats are too extreme to be given control of Congress as Election Day nears. **A4**

◆ **France confronted** scenes of destruction as its political class began pointing fingers over who bore responsibility for some of the worst rioting to sweep the nation in years. **A1**

◆ **Masked Israeli** settlers attacked a group of European diplomats in the West Bank, part of a pattern of escalating violence in the occupied territory that is straining Israel's relations with the West. **A8**

◆ **Trump endorsed** Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu for re-election, seeking to give him a long-sought boost days before Israel is set to hold a closely contested national poll. **A8**

◆ **Trump said his overhaul** of a public golf course in Washington, D.C., would begin in mid-November, pressing ahead amid a legal battle escalated by his recent actions at the site. **A3**

JOURNAL REPORT
C-Suite Strategies: Getting colleagues to say yes. **R1-6**

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MOHAMMED BADRA/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Debris and burned-out cars litter the streets of Paris on Sunday after a day of protests over the cost of living turned destructive.

French Leaders Trade Blame After Rioting Sweeps Country

By Stacy Meichtry

PARIS—France confronted scenes of destruction on Sunday—from toppled landmarks to smashed city storefronts—as its political class began pointing fingers over who bore responsibility for some of the worst rioting to sweep the nation in years.

The violence, which erupted during a nationwide protest on Saturday, resumed Sunday evening with rioters burning barricades across Paris. More than 600 police officers and firefighters were injured in the weekend mayhem, and more than 2,000 people were detained.

In a country with a long history of violent protest, the weekend riot stood out for its sheer scale, with police mostly powerless to stop thousands of rioters who descended on urban centers across the country, attacking city halls, luxury rows and other areas usually considered off-limits.

Complicating matters: The riots unfolded in a moment of political transition. France is six months away from holding presidential elections, and its current government is mired in fiscal woes that have constrained its ability to address the problems fueling protests.

The paralysis was underscored Sunday evening as President Emmanuel Macron delivered a televised address that condemned the violence but was vague about what measures the government would take to stop it. Instead, Macron invoked the coming elections and warned of politicians seizing on the chaos for political gain.

"Those who tell you today it's urgent to take to the streets, demonstrate and create disorder have but one goal: to damage the republic and hijack the debate," Macron said.

Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu said the rioters were part of highly organized far-left groups that were seeking to shape the outcome of the spring election. He also traded barbs on social media with Jean-Luc Mélenchon after the far-left leader and presidential

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Putin Bids To Meet Trump, Xi For Deal On Ukraine

Russian leader eyes favorable terms for settling war, with Zelensky frozen out

Russian President Vladimir Putin has proposed that he, President Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping meet next month to talk about Ukraine in an attempt to negotiate an end to the four-year conflict that would favor Moscow, said people familiar with the discussions.

*By **Lingling Wei, Alex Leary, Thomas Grove** and **Josh Dawsey***

The plan represents an attempt by Putin to capitalize on warming ties between Trump and the Russian leader that have alarmed Ukraine and its allies in Washington and Europe.

Such a summit—one without the involvement of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky—would be unprecedented and send alarm bells ringing in European capitals and beyond. It also comes as Trump's fellow Republicans are being pressed about why now is the time to ease pressure on Putin, a little over two weeks before midterm elections.

Putin floated the idea in an Oct. 9 phone call with Trump,

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◆ **Overtures to Russia put Republicans in a bind..... A5**
◆ **Zelensky vents frustration with Trump..... A6**
◆ **Drones hit oil terminal in St. Petersburg..... A6**

How Coke Beat Pepsi to Supply Beverages at KFC

By Heather Haddon And Laura Cooper

Inside a Yum Brands meeting room across two days in Plano, Texas, KFC executives and franchisees tasted samples from the biggest rivals in soda—Coca-Cola and PepsiCo.

The goal: to choose which company would fill beverage fountains at more than 3,000 U.S. restaurants. While Pepsi had the business for decades, its 10-year contract with the chicken chain was ending soon, people familiar with the agreement said.

The stakes for all parties were high. KFC's U.S. sales have sagged, and many in the restaurant industry see beverages as a way to excite consumers and generate stronger profits.

Coke could steal a big contract from its rival, cutting Pepsi's reach in fast food. Coke represents around 70% of U.S. carbonated soft-drink fountain sales by volume, according to industry publication Beverage Digest. KFC's chicken competitors, including fast-growing

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Too late for small fixes at Pepsi..... B9**

A Playboy Inherits Control Of Notorious Mercenaries

Son of Wagner's founder hangs on to an African stronghold

By Nicholas Bariyo

KAMPALA, Uganda—Pavel Prigozhin was still learning the family guns-for-hire business when his father's private jet exploded 28,000 feet over Russia.

Yevgeny Prigozhin's very public death, following his very public falling-out with President Vladimir Putin, left his son, Pavel, in charge of the world's most notorious mercenary force. At age 25, he inherited Wagner Group, an empire of gunfighters, gold smugglers, opioid dealers, brewers and vodka distillers.

Once seen as a pampered playboy, he turned out to be a natural.

Pavel Prigozhin, now 28, not only salvaged but expanded operations in Wagner's African stronghold, the Central African Republic, according to former Wagner associates, government officials, business people and researchers in Bangui, the capital city.

The Prigozhin family business, including both legitimate and criminal enterprises, generates more than $400 million a year, according to estimates by the Global Initiative Against Transnational Organized Crime, a Geneva-based think tank.

From a base in Bangui, Pavel Prigozhin and 500 or so mercenaries under his command have seized control of gold mines, according to the Global Initiative. They provide personal security to the president, Faustin-Archange Touadéra, and battle insurgent groups, making Prigozhin and his

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The 1980s Box-Office Flop That Fans Won't Let Go Away

* * *

Critics hated it and theaters pulled it, but 'Rad' inspires devotion of BMX bikers

By Dan Scheraga

CALGARY, Alberta—Bart Conner was a hero of the 1984 Olympics. He's been an ESPN gymnastics commentator for decades. And he's in the sport's international Hall of Fame. But when he's recognized on the street, it's usually for his appearance in a 40-year-old box-office flop about BMX racing.

Not a week goes by that he isn't spotted by fans of "Rad." In a documentary last year, he recounted a middle-aged deliveryman who was reduced to a babbling fanboy when he spied the movie poster on Conner's wall. "I don't think he ever knew I was a gymnast."

"Rad" should have been forgotten. It opened in 1986 to empty theaters and critical disdain, and failed to recoup its budget of $3 million before it was yanked from screens and effectively disappeared for 30 years.

And yet it's getting more love today than ever: It was rereleased in theaters earlier this year. Demand for a 2020 Blu-ray edition was so fierce it crashed the distributor's website. A graphic novel sequel is in the works. Skateboarding legend Tony Hawk, actor Ed Helms and NBA great Shaquille O'Neal have professed their love for what the screenwriter described as "Rocky" on bikes.

Why won't "Rad" die?

"It's one of those guilty pleasures," says Calgary-area Realtor Percy Connolly, who in

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INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
Airbnb hosts get around New York City's crackdown on short-term rentals. **A3**



SPORTS
A day of stunning upsets rattles the college-football rankings. **A16**

Fasten Your Seat Belts: Holiday Airfares Soar

By Rebecca Cadenhead And Alison Sider

When Ehren Minkema flew from Austin, Texas, to Minneapolis for Christmas last year, he paid $424 round trip.

About a week ago, Minkema bought a nearly identical itinerary for this year's trip. The new price: $722.

"I had to think about what sacrifices I am willing to make to book my trip home," said Minkema, a 35-year-old who lives in Austin.

"While also knowing that the longer I wait, prices will just continue to get more expensive."

Airfares this holiday season will be the highest they have been in at least a decade, according to data compiled by Hopper, a travel-booking company.

So far, the average domestic round-trip ticket this Thanksgiving travel period is 31% more expensive than last year, while the price of a ticket for Christmas is 23% higher.

The stakes are high for airlines in one of the year's busiest air-travel windows. Carriers have had to find ways to boost revenue to deal with rising energy costs since the Iran War began to disrupt global crude oil flows and production in the Middle East.

Executives have said so far, they have been able to push fares higher without damaging demand, and they don't expect the prices to keep holiday travelers away.

Jet fuel is one of the biggest single expenses for carriers, and they expect to pay tens of billions of dollars more for it than last year.

The average monthly spot price of jet fuel is around

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